

Children, Custody & Parenting Plans :Interview Practice Questions

(answer truthfully; don't guess if unsure).

1) Children overview (who has children and basic details)

- Do either of you have children (together or from previous relationships)?
- How many children, and what are their names and ages (only if relevant and comfortable)?
- Where do the children live most of the time?
- Do the children live with you full-time, part-time, or visit occasionally?
- Are there any other adults involved in caregiving (co-parent, grandparents, guardians)?

2) Custody / visitation schedule (high consistency area)

- Is there a formal custody agreement (court order) or an informal schedule?
- What is the regular schedule (which days/nights are with you vs with the other parent/guardian)?
- Who does drop-offs and pick-ups on school days and weekends?
- Where do exchanges happen (school, a parent's home, neutral location)?
- How is the schedule handled during holidays and school vacations?
- What happens if someone needs to swap days (how do you communicate changes)?

3) School details and involvement

- Which school/daycare do the children attend (name/area)?
- Who is listed as primary contact at school?
- Who typically handles school communication (emails/calls/parent portal)?
- Who attends parent-teacher conferences (and when was the most recent one)?
- Who helps with homework and bedtime reading (if applicable)?
- Who packs lunches or prepares school items in the morning?

4) Medical and appointments

- Who schedules medical/dental appointments for the children?
- Where do the children go for primary care (clinic/doctor's office, general area)?
- Who usually takes them to appointments?
- Do you share health insurance for the children? Whose plan are they on (if known)?
- Do you keep medical records or immunization records? Where are they stored?
- Any ongoing medications or special needs routines (only if relevant and comfortable)?

5) Daily routines (meals, bedtime, screen time)

- What is the typical weekday routine when the children are with you (wake-up, breakfast, school, dinner, bedtime)?
- What time is bedtime on school nights vs weekends?
- Who cooks for the children and what are typical meals/snacks?
- Do you have screen-time rules (TV/tablet/phone)? What are they?
- Any chores or responsibilities the children have at home?

6) Discipline and parenting approach

- How do you handle discipline (timeouts, loss of privileges, calm talks, routine charts)?
- Are you generally aligned on discipline styles, or do you handle things differently?
- Who is more strict and who is more lenient (if that's true)?
- How do you resolve disagreements about parenting decisions?

7) Childcare and supervision

- Do you use childcare or after-school programs? Where and which days?
- Who pays for childcare or extracurricular activities (if applicable)?
- Who watches the children if one person is working late?
- Do the children stay with relatives sometimes? Who and how often?

8) Extracurriculars and social life

- Do the children have extracurricular activities (sports, lessons, clubs)? Which ones?
- Who signs them up and who takes them to activities?
- Do you attend games/performances together?
- Who are the children's close friends—do you know their parents?

9) Co-parenting and communication with the other parent (if applicable)

- How do you communicate with the other parent (text, app, email)?
- How often do you communicate about the children?
- Is communication usually smooth or sometimes difficult (keep it factual)?
- Are there any standing rules about travel, school decisions, or emergencies?

10) Home setup for children (where they sleep and what they have)

- Do the children have their own room, shared room, or sleeping area?
- What items do you keep for them (bed, clothes, toys, school supplies)?
- Where are their clothes stored (dresser drawers, closet section)?
- Do you keep any special items for comfort (stuffed animals, blankets)?

11) Financial responsibilities (basic, truthful)

- Do you pay child support or receive child support (if applicable)?
- Who pays for major expenses (school supplies, clothes, medical copays)?
- How do you track shared expenses (receipts, app, informal)?

12) “Reality check” questions (recent and specific)

- When was the last time the children stayed with you and what did you do together?
- Who did the most recent pick-up/drop-off and where?
- What did the children eat for dinner the last time they were with you?
- What was the last school-related message or event you dealt with?
- Any recent doctor/dentist visit—who took them and why (general reason)?

Tip: If you're not sure about a detail, it's better to say "I don't remember exactly" than to guess. Keep answers factual and consistent with any custody paperwork.